

YINGAO (ELAINE) YAO

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<https://elaineyao.github.io/>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research interests are at the intersection of Software Engineering and Machine Learning (ML). I am particularly interested in developing software testing techniques (e.g., fuzzing) to improve the security, reliability, and correctness of ML systems.

EDUCATION

Cornell University Ph.D. in Computer Science. Advisor: Dr. Saikat Dutta.	<i>September 2024 - Present</i>
University of British Columbia MSc. Electrical and Computer Engineering. Advisor: Dr. Karthik Pattabiraman.	<i>September 2021 - December 2023</i>
University of Electronic Science and Technology of China B.E. Electrical and Communication Engineering GPA: 3.96/4.0	<i>September 2017 - June 2021</i>

PUBLICATIONS

Automated Assertion Generation and Regression Testing for Machine Learning Notebooks Yingao (Elaine) Yao, Vedant Nimje, Varun Viswanath, and Saikat Dutta. IEEE/ACM International Conference on Automated Software Engineering. 🏆 ACM SIGSOFT Distinguished Paper Award	<i>ASE 2026</i>
SwarmFuzz: Discovering GPS Spoofing Attacks in Drone Swarms Yingao (Elaine) Yao, Pritam Dash, and Karthik Pattabiraman. IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (DSN).	<i>DSN 2023</i>
Poster: May the Swarm Be With You: Sensor Spoofing Attacks Against Drone Swarms Yingao (Elaine) Yao, Pritam Dash, and Karthik Pattabiraman. ACM SIGSAC Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS).	<i>CCS 2023</i>

PREPRINTS

ICS-Sniper: A Targeted Blackhole Attack on Encrypted ICS Traffic Gargi Mitra, Pritam Dash, Yingao Elaine Yao, Aastha Mehta, and Karthik Pattabiraman. https://arxiv.org/abs/2312.06140 .	<i>arXiv 2023</i>
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HONORS AND AWARDS

ACM SIGSOFT Distinguished Paper Award	<i>2026</i>
IEEE DSN Student Travel Grant Award	<i>2023</i>
Faculty of Applied Science Graduate Award, University of British Columbia	<i>2022</i>
Outstanding Graduate, Sichuan Province	<i>2021</i>
Outstanding Winner, COMAP Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling	<i>2020</i>
Thanksgiving Scholarship for Modern Scientists	<i>2020</i>

National Scholarship 2020
National Second Prize in China Undergraduate Mathematical Contest in Modeling 2018

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Security Researcher Jan 2024 - Aug 2024
Fortinet, Vancouver, Canada.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for CS 5150: Software Engineering Spring 2025
Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA

Teaching Assistant for CPEN 321: Software Engineering Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Spring 2023
University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Artifact Evaluation Program Committee 2024
19th USENIX Symposium on Operating Systems Design and Implementation (OSDI).
European Conference on Object-Oriented Programming (ECOOP).
18th USENIX WOOT Conference on Offensive Technologies (WOOT).
ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS).
USENIX Annual Technical Conference (USENIX ATC).
The 54th Annual IEEE/IFIP International Conference on Dependable Systems and Networks (DSN).

Artifact Evaluation Program Committee 2023
The 34th IEEE International Symposium on Software Reliability Engineering (ISSRE).

DEPARTMENT SERVICE

Department of Computer Science, Picnic Czar Fall 2025, Spring 2026
Cornell University, Ithaca, NY.

MENTORING

David Jovic (BS, University of Belgrade)
Arpan Chakraborty (BS, Adamas University)
Vedant Ramesh Nimje (BS, Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute, Mumbai)
Varun Viswanath (BS, Dwarkadas J Sanghvi College of Engineering)
Parshwa Nandu (BS, Dwarkadas J Sanghvi College of Engineering)

PRESENTATIONS

SwarmFuzz: Discovering GPS Spoofing Attacks in Drone Swarms DSN 2023
Poster: May the Swarm Be With You: Sensor Spoofing Attacks Against Drone Swarms. CCS 2023

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

SwarmFuzz: <https://github.com/DependableSystemsLab/SwarmFuzz>
NBTest: <https://github.com/seal-research/NBTest>